Figure 11. Distribution and Equity

Rank (highest to lowest)	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	Mean
Equity												
Horizontal inequity index, %[a]	US 5.30	Canada 2.20	France 1.10	Germany 0.80	NLD 0.50	UK 0.40	Sweden 0.30	Denmark -1.30	CHE NA	Japan NA	Australia NA	1.16 (n = 8)
Out-of-pocket spending												
As % of total health expenditure[b]	CHE 22.0	Australia 15.9	Canada 15.3	UK 14.6	Denmark 13.9	Sweden 13.4	Japan 12.2	NLD 11.8	US 10.9	Germany 10.7	France 9.2	13.6
As % of household consumption	CHE 3.8	Australia 3.2	Denmark 2.9	Sweden 2.8	US 2.5	NLD 2.4	Canada 2.3	Japan 2.2	UK 1.6	Germany 1.4	France 1.3	2.4
Unmet need[c]												
Consultation skipped because of cost	US 26.8	Australia 19.1	CHE 18.3	Canada 8.9	Sweden 6.3	NLD 4.7	UK 4.6	Germany 3.5	France 3.3	Denmark NA	Japan NA	10.6 (n = 9)
% Unmet need, below-average income	US 46	Australia 33	CHE 28	Canada 24	Sweden 19[f]	UK 16	Germany 16	France 16	NLD 16	Denmark NA	Japan NA	24 (n = 9)
% Unmet need, above-average income	US 29	Australia 25	CHE 18	Canada 12	UK 10	Germany 8	Sweden 6[f]	France 6	NLD 6	Denmark NA	Japan NA	13 (n = 9)
Geographic breakdown												
Rural population, % of total population	France 21	US 20	Germany 18	Canada 17	UK 17	CHE 14	Australia 12	Denmark 11	Sweden 11	Japan 8	NLD 4	14
Population density per sq km[d]	NLD 531	Japan 342	UK 283	Germany 238	CHE 225	Denmark 149	France 127	US 37	Sweden 26	Canada 5	Australia 4	179
Urban physicians per 1000 population[e]	CHE 5.4	Sweden 4.8	Australia 4.7	France 4.1	Japan 2.7	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	NLD NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	4.3 (n = 5)
Rural physicians per 1000 population	CHE 4.2	Sweden 4.2	Australia 3.3	France 2.7	Japan 2.6	US NA	UK NA	Germany NA	NLD NA	Denmark NA	Canada NA	3.4 (n = 5)

NA indicates not available (no comparable modern observation). CHE indicates Switzerland; NLD, the Netherlands. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest value within each row; NA cells are placed at the right.

Mean is the unweighted arithmetic mean of the countries with data; (n = x) under a mean gives the number of countries contributing when data were not available (NA) for all 11.

[a] Need-standardized horizontal inequity index ×100 for the probability of a physician visit in the past 12 months, by income (survey data 2014-2016). If greater than 0, high-income groups visit physicians more than low-income groups after adjustment for need.

[b] Share of current health expenditure.

[c] Commonwealth Fund 2023 survey: did not visit a physician, skipped a test, treatment, or follow-up, or did not fill a prescription or skipped doses because of cost in the past year, by self-reported household income below or above the national average. Consultation skipped because of cost: OECD (mostly 2020 Commonwealth Fund data).

[d] Persons per square kilometer of land; the 2018 label read per square mile but its values were also per square kilometer.

[e] Physicians per 1000 population in OECD predominantly urban vs predominantly rural small regions (TL3); only countries with TL3 physician data are shown (Germany excluded because its regional counts cover ambulatory physicians only).

[f] Sweden, 2020 survey (income data not collected in Sweden in 2023).

2026 update. Each value is the most recent comparable observation for that country (observation years 2014–2025; most values 2023–2025); data retrieved October 7, 2026. The year and source of every cell are listed in the accompanying workbook (Master_Data sheet). Sources: OECD, Health for Everyone? (2019) (horizontal inequity); WHO Global Health Expenditure Database via World Bank (out-of-pocket share); OECD System of Health Accounts (out-of-pocket share of household consumption); OECD Health Care Quality and Outcomes (consultation skipped); Commonwealth Fund International Health Policy Survey 2023 (unmet need); World Bank World Development Indicators (rural population, density); OECD Regional Statistics (urban and rural physicians).